



Trade and exploration

Wooden hull is approximately 58 ft (17.7 m) long

Main mast top castle manned by crew member searching for land

Lateen sails used when winds blew toward the side of the ship

Caravel Portugal 1490s

Santa Maria
Spain 1460

When the *Santa Maria* was finally **broken up**, the wood was used to build a **fort**.

Hull is approximately 90 ft (27.5 m) long

Short, deep wooden hull could carry plenty of cargo below decks

Mayflower England 1600s

Mizzen mast added to ship when it was converted from a warship to a survey vessel

HMS Beagle England 1820

HMS Bounty England 1784

Hull converted to transport breadfruit plants from Tahiti to the Caribbean

Ship carried 74 people on a five-year survey voyage

From the 15th century onward, European sailing ships traveled the world. Many were trading vessels, carrying cargoes as varied as slaves, food, and spices. Others explored new lands, on epic voyages of discovery.

Portugal was a major sea trading nation in the 15th century, and **caravels** sailed along the coasts of Europe and Africa. Two accompanied the **Santa Maria** on Christopher Columbus' famous 1492 voyage across the Atlantic. Many European ships would later head west for trade, or to conquer, or